

Meridian IP and Commercialization Brief

Protection, positioning, revenue, and go-to-market strategy

MERIDIAN

Project record - August 26, 2026

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Executive conclusion

Meridian has credible commercial and intellectual-property potential, but its value will come from an implemented, trusted product rather than ownership of a broad idea. The recommended path is a premium household subscription, validated through concierge onboarding, followed by advisor, employer, and white-label distribution.

Initial market position

Meridian should serve financially complex households with multiple accounts, shared obligations, irregular income, scattered bills and receipts, and a need for clarity without manual budgeting. Its promise is: one trustworthy picture of what happened, what is coming, why the system believes it, and what needs attention.

Revenue model

- Meridian Individual: approximately \$15-\$20 per month.
- Meridian Household: approximately \$30-\$45 per month.
- Use a time-limited trial or money-back guarantee instead of a permanent feature-rich free tier.
- Do not sell financial data, use advertising, or accept paid placement inside recommendations.

Go-to-market sequence

- 1. Recruit 10 design-partner households for founder-led onboarding.
- 2. Prove document-to-transaction reconciliation, Commitment discovery, funding forecasts, and explainable review.
- 3. Convert the strongest five households to paid use.
- 4. Expand to 25-50 founding households through referrals.
- 5. Measure retention, correction rate, classification precision, time saved, detected savings, avoided problems, and willingness to pay.
- 6. After retention is established, launch professional advisor seats, employer financial-wellness contracts, and provider-neutral white-label APIs.

Defensible assets

- Financial Evidence Graph and reconciliation architecture
- Longitudinal, permissioned financial memory
- Correction-derived household rules and confidence calibration
- Provider normalization and provenance
- Document, charge, reimbursement, obligation, and payment resolution
- Explainable forecasts and proposal-only financial automation
- Cohesive product design, brand, security controls, and customer trust
- Evaluation datasets and measurable real-world outcomes

Protection strategy

Use layered protection:

- Copyright for eligible human-authored code, specifications, writing, and visual expression.
- Trademark for Meridian and distinctive identifiers after clearance.
- Trade secrets for confidential scoring, prompts, evaluation systems, reconciliation techniques, and proprietary data.
- Patent review for concrete, novel technical mechanisms in evidence reconciliation, confidence propagation, temporal matching, correction learning, and action-safety boundaries.

The general use case, program logic, method, system, and interface layout cannot be monopolized through copyright. A provisional patent application may preserve an early U.S. filing date, but public disclosure can impair foreign rights. Obtain qualified intellectual-property counsel before publishing detailed invention mechanics.

Commercial expansion

After consumer validation:

- Advisor edition: permissioned household cockpit priced per professional and client seat.
- Employer benefit: private employee financial-wellness product with aggregate-only employer reporting.
- White-label platform: annual platform fee plus active-user or API usage for credit unions, payroll companies, accounting platforms, and personal-finance applications.

Avoid autonomous money movement, investment recommendations, lending, insurance lead generation, and broad bank sales until the product, controls, and regulatory posture are mature.

Primary references

- U.S. Copyright Office, What Does Copyright Protect: <https://www.copyright.gov/help/faq/faq-protect.html>
- U.S. Copyright Office, Computer Programs: <https://www.copyright.gov/register/tx-programs.html>
- USPTO, Patent Subject Matter Eligibility: <https://www.uspto.gov/web/offices/pac/mpep/s2106.html>
- USPTO, Provisional Patent Applications: <https://www.uspto.gov/patents/basics/apply/provisional-application>
- USPTO, Trademark Basics: <https://www.uspto.gov/trademarks/basics>
- USPTO, Intellectual Property Overview: <https://www.uspto.gov/learning-and-resources/getting-started>
- U.S. Copyright Office, AI Report Part 2 announcement: <https://www.copyright.gov/newsnet/2025/1060.html>